

07

SENTENCE IMPROVEMENT

Generally, 10 to 15 questions based on sentence improvement are asked in the CDS exam. In these questions, a part of the given sentences is underlined. Out of the given options, the candidate has to choose the option which improves the sentence. In case, there is no improvement, option (d) needs to be selected which stands for 'No improvement'.



Questions based on Sentence Improvement are designed to test a candidate's knowledge of English Grammar and Vocabulary simultaneously. In such questions, a sentence is given with a part underlined. For this part, some alternatives are given below the sentence.

The candidate has to choose the option which improves the sentence. A sound knowledge of grammatical rules is highly beneficial in solving such questions.

Direction (Example) Which option improves the underlined part of the given sentence? In case, the sentence cannot be improved further, choose option (d).

The girl is wise despite her age.

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| (a) is her | (b) than her |
| (c) for her | (d) at her |

Explanation (c) In the above sentence, underlined part is 'despite her'. We have to choose the option which will improve the sentence. Among the given options, 'for her' is best option which improves the sentence and makes it grammatically correct. The other options are incorrect. Hence, option (c) is the correct choice.

IMPROVE THE SENTENCES

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-110) Select the option which improves the **underlined** part of the sentences. In case, there is no improvement, choose option (d).

1. He could not look anything in the dark room.
(a) look at
(b) see
(c) see through
(d) No improvement
2. He was fined for careless driving.
(a) got fined
(b) fined
(c) was to be fined
(d) No improvement
3. We look forward to hear from you.
(a) hearing
(b) have heard
(c) listen
(d) No improvement
4. When the examinations were over Anil and me went to our native town.
(a) me and Anil
(b) Anil and I
(c) I and Anil
(d) No improvement
5. Will you kindly open the knot?
(a) untie
(b) break
(c) loose
(d) No improvement
6. Realising the significance of technical education for developing our country, the government laid aside a large sum on it during the last plan-period.
(a) laid up
(b) set aside
(c) laid out
(d) No improvement
7. Other countries have eradicated this disease ten years ago.
(a) eradicated
(b) had eradicated
(c) did eradicate
(d) No improvement
8. We were not the wiser for all this effort to explain the case to us.
(a) none
(b) neither
(c) nevertheless
(d) No improvement
9. If I stood alone in defence of truth, and the whole world is banded against me and against truth, I would fight them all.
(a) will be banded
(b) were banded
(c) banded
(d) No improvement
10. During his long discourse, he did not touch that point.
(a) touch upon
(b) touch on
(c) touch of
(d) No improvement
11. He has not and can never be in the good books of his employer because he lacks honesty.
(a) has not and cannot be
(b) has not and can never been
(c) has not been and can never be
(d) No improvement
12. This matter admits of no excuse.
(a) admits to
(b) admits from
(c) admits
(d) No improvement
13. You have come here with a view to insult me.
(a) to insulting me
(b) of insulting me
(c) for insulting me
(d) No improvement
14. For all powers of reason and understanding, we know a little about life's secrets.
(a) a little of love secrets
(b) little about life's secrets
(c) nothing about life's secrets
(d) No improvement
15. I will not go to school, if it shall rain tomorrow.
(a) it would rain tomorrow
(b) it will rain tomorrow
(c) it rains tomorrow
(d) No improvement
16. Why the dinosaurs died out is not known.
(a) it is not known
(b) the reason is not known
(c) that is not known
(d) No improvement
17. He is quite well now, except a slight cold.
(a) except with a slight cold
(b) excepting a slight cold
(c) except for a slight cold
(d) No improvement
18. His powerful desire brought about his downfall.
(a) His intense desire
(b) His desire for power
(c) His fatal desire
(d) No improvement
19. If he would have tried, he would have succeeded.
(a) is tried
(b) was tried
(c) had tried
(d) No improvement
20. I hope you vividly remember the premier of the film when I, my wife and you were present in the hall.
(a) my wife, I and you
(b) you, I and my wife
(c) my wife, you and I
(d) No improvement
21. With a thundering roar the huge rocket soared up from the launching pad.
(a) flew up
(b) went upwards
(c) took off
(d) No improvement
22. My opinion for the film is that it will bag the national award.
(a) opinion to
(b) opinion about
(c) opinion on
(d) No improvement

- 23.** He sent a word to me that he would be coming late.
(a) sent word
(b) had sent a word
(c) sent words
(d) No improvement
- 24.** It became clear that the strangers were heading into a serious disaster.
(a) along
(b) towards
(c) for
(d) No improvement
- 25.** Fifty kilometres are not a great distance in these days of fast moving vehicles.
(a) is not a great distance
(b) is no distance
(c) aren't a great distance
(d) No improvement
- 26.** Whatever to our other problems, we have no shortcoming of cheap labour in India.
(a) default
(b) deficit
(c) scarcity
(d) No improvement
- 27.** It was indeed a shock for her, but she has later recovered from it.
(a) since
(b) then
(c) afterwards
(d) No improvement
- 28.** There is dearth of woman doctor in our state. We shall have to recruit some from the other states.
(a) women doctor
(b) woman doctors
(c) women doctors
(d) No improvement
- 29.** The poor villagers have waited in the bitter cold for more than four hours now.
(a) have been waiting
(b) had waited
(c) has been waiting
(d) No improvement
- 30.** Most donors would seriously protest any effort to extrapolate from such limited data.
(a) protest against
(b) protest at
(c) protest to
(d) No improvement
- 31.** The greatest thing in style is to have a use of metaphor.
(a) knowledge (b) command
(c) need (d) No improvement
- 32.** Infact, if it hadn't been for his invaluable advice on so many occasions I wouldn't have achieved anything in life.
(a) remarkable advice
(b) valuable advices
(c) priceless suggestion
(d) No improvement
- 33.** To get one's name in the Rowland Ward's book of hunting records was the hot ambition of every serious hunter.
(a) extreme (b) burning
(c) high (d) No improvement
- 34.** I have lived in Delhi since I was four.
(a) am living (b) lived
(c) had lived (d) No improvement
- 35.** My friend was in hospital for a week after an accident.
(a) through (b) following
(c) for (d) No improvement
- 36.** I want you to clearly understand that matter.
(a) you clearly to understand
(b) you to understand clearly
(c) to clearly understand you
(d) No improvement
- 37.** If you cross the line, you will be disqualified.
(a) cross upon the line
(b) cross on the line
(c) cross out the line
(d) No improvement
- 38.** No sooner he had returned home then his mother felt happy.
(a) had he returned home when
(b) he had returned home than
(c) did he return home than
(d) No improvement
- 39.** There is no more room for you in this compartment.
(a) There is no more seat
(b) There is no more space
(c) There is no more accommodation
(d) No improvement
- 40.** Young men and women should get habituated to reading and writing about current affairs.
(a) used (b) prepared
(c) trained (d) No improvement
- 41.** While crossing the highway, a five year old child was knocked out by a passing car.
(a) away
(b) up
(c) down
(d) No improvement
- 42.** Every time I go in a lift to my sixth floor apartment, I remember the calm and serenity of my ancestral home in the village.
(a) move in a lift
(b) ascend in a lift
(c) take a lift
(d) No improvement
- 43.** He found a wooden broken chair in the room.
(a) wooden and broken chair
(b) broken wooden chair
(c) broken and wooden chair
(d) No improvement
- 44.** If the room had been brighter, I would have been able to read for a while before bed time.
(a) If the room was brighter
(b) If the room are brighter
(c) Had the room been brighter
(d) No improvement
- 45.** Practically, every part of the banana tree is used by man.
(a) each part
(b) any part
(c) most part
(d) No improvement
- 46.** Hoping not to be disturbed, I sat down in my easy chair to read the book I won as a prize.
(a) I had won as a prize
(b) I have won as prize
(c) I had to win as a prize
(d) No improvement
- 47.** His father won't be able to leave for Varanasi until they have arrived.
(a) until they arrive
(b) until they will have arrived
(c) until they will arrive
(d) No improvement
- 48.** The company goes to great length to ensure that employees can be comfortable in their work environment.
(a) are comfortable
(b) will be comfortable
(c) should be comfortable
(d) No improvement

49. The reason why he wrote the letter was because he could not contact him over the phone.
 (a) why he wrote the letter was since
 (b) for which he wrote the letter because
 (c) why he wrote the letter was that
 (d) No improvement
50. I shall be grateful to you if you are of help to me now.
 (a) help (b) would help
 (c) helped (d) No improvement
51. Will you lend me few rupees in this hour of need?
 (a) lend me any rupees
 (b) borrow me a few rupees
 (c) lend me a few rupees
 (d) No improvement
52. He should move on to the next point and not harp one string only.
 (a) harp on string only
 (b) harp only one string
 (c) harp upon one string only
 (d) No improvement
53. Please make it a point to send a letter at my address.
 (a) on my address
 (b) to my address
 (c) in my address
 (d) No improvement
54. The demonstration passed off peacefully.
 (a) passed out (b) passed away
 (c) passed on (d) No improvement
55. This telephone number is not existing.
 (a) has not existed
 (b) does not exist
 (c) has not been existing
 (d) No improvement
56. Whenever my students come across new words, I ask them to look for them in the dictionary.
 (a) to look it up
 (b) to look them up
 (c) to look at them
 (d) No improvement
57. Please remind me of posting these letters to my relatives.
 (a) by posting
 (b) to post
 (c) for posting
 (d) No improvement
58. If you are living near a market place you should be ready to bear the disturbances caused by traffic.
 (a) to bear upon
 (b) to bear with
 (c) to bear away
 (d) No improvement
59. I shall not go until I am invited.
 (a) till I am invited
 (b) unless I am invited
 (c) if not I am invited
 (d) No improvement
60. I took the cycle which he bought yesterday.
 (a) that he bought yesterday
 (b) that which he had bought yesterday
 (c) that he had bought yesterday
 (d) No improvement
61. If you had attended the meeting, you would have benefitted a great deal.
 (a) could benefit
 (b) would benefit
 (c) benefitted
 (d) No improvement
62. The cloud of misfortunes appears to have blown out.
 (a) over
 (b) up
 (c) away
 (d) No improvement
63. We had nothing to eat since 8'o clock, this morning.
 (a) have had nothing
 (b) has had nothing
 (c) did have nothing
 (d) No improvement
64. If you are not clear about the meaning of a word, it is wise to look into a dictionary.
 (a) look for
 (b) look at
 (c) look up
 (d) No improvement
65. They are social insects, living in communities, regulated by definite laws, each member of society bearing well-defined and separate part in the work of a colony.
 (a) who are living in communities
 (b) living among a community
 (c) who lives with a community
 (d) No improvement
66. The dissidents hold a great problem in every political party.
 (a) cause
 (b) give
 (c) pose
 (d) No improvement
67. Not long back, in Japan, a mysterious nerve gas affected a large number of people.
 (a) effected
 (b) infected
 (c) infested
 (d) No improvement
68. As she was suffering from high fever, she could not face the examination.
 (a) bear
 (b) suffer
 (c) take
 (d) No improvement
69. As he is past his teens now, he can look for himself.
 (a) after
 (b) to
 (c) around
 (d) No improvement
70. Either he or I am going.
 (a) he or I are going
 (b) he is going or I am
 (c) I or he is going
 (d) No improvement
71. It will be no good trying to find an excuse next time.
 (a) to try to find
 (b) to try finding
 (c) trying finding
 (d) No improvement
72. We did not see this movie yet.
 (a) have seen
 (b) have not seen
 (c) has seen
 (d) No improvement
73. She says she's already paid me back, but I can't remember, so I'll have to take her word.
 (a) to take her word true
 (b) to take her at her word
 (c) to take her word for it
 (d) No improvement
74. The end of the examinations is opportunity for celebrating.
 (a) chance
 (b) moment
 (c) occasion
 (d) No improvement

- 75.** When it was feared that the serfs might go too far and gain their freedom from serfdom, the protestant leaders joined the princes at crushing them.
(a) into crushing
(b) in crushing
(c) without crushing
(d) No improvement
- 76.** In India, today many of our intellectuals still talk in terms of the French Revolution and the Rights of Man, not appreciating that much has happened since then.
(a) much has been happening
(b) much had happened
(c) much might happen
(d) No improvement
- 77.** Our office clock is not so correct as it should be, it is usually five minutes fast.
(a) right
(b) regular
(c) accurate
(d) No improvement
- 78.** You cannot forbid him leaving.
(a) he leaving
(b) his leaving
(c) him to leave
(d) No improvement
- 79.** I hope you won't object to me watching while you work.
(a) against me watching
(b) me to watch
(c) to my watching
(d) No improvement
- 80.** But in all these cases conversion from one scale to another is easy because scales have well-formulated.
(a) can be well-formulated
(b) are well-formulated
(c) well-formulated
(d) No improvement
- 81.** The more they earn, more they spend.
(a) More they earn, more they spend
(b) More they earn, the more they spend
(c) The more they earn, the more they spend
(d) No improvement
- 82.** Although, India is still by far a poor country, it can become rich if its natural and human resources are fully utilised.
(a) few and far between
(b) by and large
(c) by and by
(d) No improvement
- 83.** Due to these reasons, we are all in favour of universal compulsory education.
(a) Out of these reasons
(b) For these reasons
(c) By these reasons
(d) No improvement
- 84.** While we would like that all Indian children to go to school, we need to ponder why they do not.
(a) that all the Indian children
(b) if all the children of India
(c) all Indian children
(d) No improvement
- 85.** You are warned against committing the same mistake again.
(a) to commit
(b) for committing
(c) against to commit
(d) No improvement
- 86.** The workers are hell bent at getting what is due to them.
(a) hell bent on getting
(b) hell bent for getting
(c) hell bent upon getting
(d) No improvement
- 87.** He died in the year 1960 at 11pm on 14th July.
(a) on 14th July in the year 1960 at 11pm
(b) in the year 1960 on 14th July at 11pm
(c) at 11pm on 14th July in the year 1960
(d) No improvement
- 88.** The logic of Berlin wall already had been undermined but when the news came through that the wall itself had been opened I jumped into a car.
(a) had been undermined already
(b) had already been undermined
(c) had been already undermined
(d) No improvement
- 89.** Tax-payers are to be conscious of their privileges.
(a) have to (b) need
(c) ought to (d) No improvement
- 90.** I would have waited for you at the station if I knew that you would come.
(a) had known (b) was knowing
(c) have known (d) No improvement
- 91.** No one could explain how a calm and balanced person like him could penetrate such a mindless act on his friends.
(a) perpetuate (b) perpetrate
(c) precipitate (d) No improvement
- 92.** The old man felled some trees in the garden with hardly no effort at all.
(a) hard effort
(b) hardly any effort
(c) a hardly any effort
(d) No improvement
- 93.** Five years ago today, I am sitting in a small Japanese car, driving across Poland towards Berlin.
(a) was sitting
(b) sat
(c) have been sitting
(d) No improvement
- 94.** Sumit had told me that he hasn't done it yet.
(a) told (b) tells
(c) was telling (d) No improvement
- 95.** The record for the biggest tiger hunt has not been met since 1911 when Lord Hardinge, then Viceroy of India, shot a tiger that measured 11 ft and 6 inches.
(a) improved (b) broken
(c) bettered (d) No improvement
- 96.** The man ran as quickly as he could to catch the bus.
(a) quick (b) quicker
(c) quickest (d) No improvement
- 97.** Are you plan to go to the museum today?
(a) plans to (b) planned to
(c) planning to (d) No improvement
- 98.** The demonetisation with currency is taking place these days.
(a) demonetising on
(b) demonetisation of
(c) demonetisation as
(d) No improvement